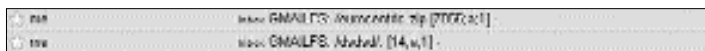


called Gmail Drive. Use GD as you would any other drive on the system. Double-click to open the drive. If you haven't logged in yet, a pop-up will ask you to do so. Once logged in, you can see the files that already exist in the drive. Right-clicking on the drive and checking its properties will show the used and free space.

To store files, you copy and paste as you normally would in the case of any other drive. GD integrates into Windows Explorer and shows up under the "Send to" options when you right-click on a file. Since the data needs to be uploaded to the drive, the speed of your Net connection will dictate the process time.



Gmail Drive Messages

One usual file manipulation procedure not permitted is renaming. All the rest, like creating a new folder (the "NEW FOLDER" name cannot be used), transferring of files from one folder to another, and so on, can be accomplished. Saving files directly from an application to the drive cannot be done, though, since the drive just doesn't show up as a drive with a letter.

In case you're wondering if there's a way to know if the mailbox is being used—you'd be dead not to notice! What Gmail Drive does in the background is send an e-mail with the file as an attachment. These show up in your Inbox as sent by "me". All file manipulations, like creating of a new folder and transferring of files between folders, will also show up as e-mails in the Inbox. If you uninstall Gmail Drive, the files in the drive will still be accessible from your Inbox.

In conclusion, Gmail Drive is a handy application that allows putting the Gmail mailbox to better use. But given Google's displeasure regarding extensive use of the tool, it is not recommended for users planning to store and retrieve large files frequently on a daily basis. While it does accomplish its core task of uploading files to Gmail without hassles, the semi-polished nature of the product cannot escape a frown.